



WhatsApp group calls

WhatsApp is rolling out Call Links to make it easier to start and join a call in just one tap. <https://digit.in/oct22-29>



"Corrupted" Google Photos

Several Google Photos users have complained that their old photographs had been "corrupted". <https://digit.in/oct22-30>

In the battle against air pollution, Will air-purifying helmets help?

An ingenious helmet promoted by a Delhi-based startup promises riders a breath of fresh air, but only at a premium price.

Anup Semwal | feedback@digit.in

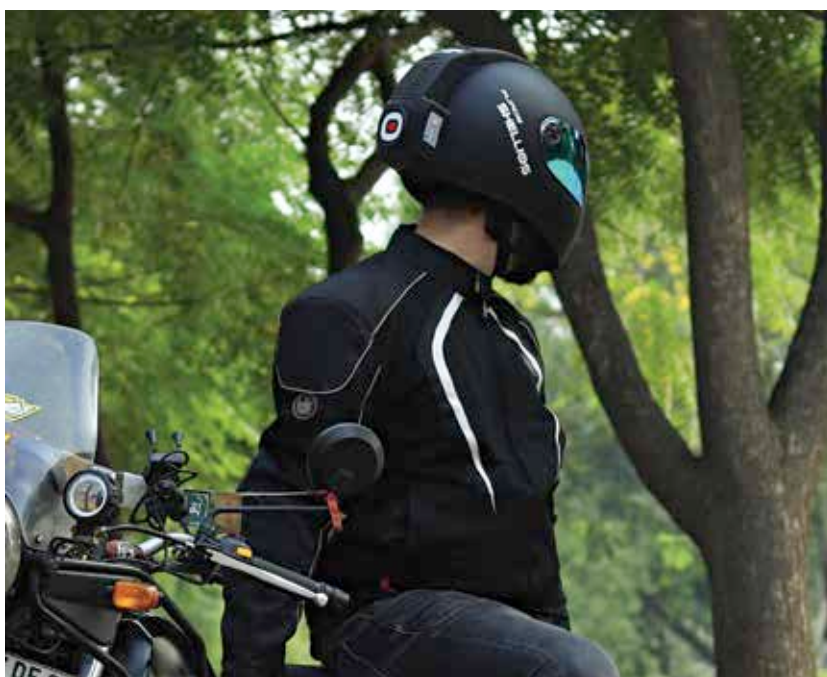
D

elhi-based startup Shellios Technolabs has recently patented an air-purifying helmet. Unless

looked at with a keen eye, the anti-pollution helmet deftly passes off as any other ordinary helmet in the market – until the prying onlooker chances upon its backside.

Though inconspicuous, it is the backside of Shellios's helmet, fitted with a blower fan, a filter membrane and an electronic circuit, that makes it a new ball game in the protective headgear industry: Like commonplace helmets, it protects the skull from injuries during an unlucky crash; unlike commonplace helmets, it also protects the lungs from Particulate Matter 2.5 (PM2.5), which, arguably, is the single biggest environmental threat to human health.

"We have got an air-purification system attached behind the shell of



the helmet," says Amit Pathak, the engineer who designed the helmet from scratch. "When you press the button on the backside, the fan fitted inside the helmet switches on, which pulls in air and passes it through a

filter membrane. The filter sifts out PM2.5 particles, and the clean air is then circulated through the ducting to the breathing area of the bike rider. Further, there is a chin-curtain, so that the polluted air does not re-enter from the front side."

In other words, the helmet, suitably named Puros, filters out lung-damaging PM2.5 particles from the air before it reaches the rider's nostrils. The tests on New Delhi's streets by an independent laboratory confirm that the helmet can filter out more than 80% of pollutants. A 2019 test report seen by Digit shows that

